

General Intern Policy and Guidelines

ACCESS LEVEL: PUBLIC / INTERN TIER

TIER 1 - INTERN

Welcome to NovaTech Innovations. This handbook serves as the foundational guide for all interns joining our organization across various technical, product, and functional departments. As an intern, you play a vital role in supporting our daily team objectives while acquiring hands-on industry experience in a dynamic workplace.

1. Intern Onboarding

Your onboarding process officially begins on your first day with a company-wide orientation session conducted by Human Resources. During this session, you will receive your corporate IT credentials, workstation setup instructions, and initial security provisioning for our internal developer portal and learning systems.

Following HR orientation, you will meet with your assigned buddy and direct supervisor. They will walk you through the team workspace, introduce key stakeholders, and outline your preliminary deliverables for the first two weeks. All onboarding checklists must be completed and submitted in the Intern Portal within your first five business days.

2. Intern Responsibilities

Interns are expected to actively participate in team activities, demonstrate continuous learning, ask questions when blocked, and deliver quality contributions under mentor supervision. Core responsibilities include:

- Assisting software engineers and product teams with daily operational tasks, codebase maintenance, and documentation.
- Writing modular, well-tested code or preparing draft technical reports based on given specifications.
- Attending daily stand-up meetings, weekly team synchronization meetings, and monthly intern cohort check-ins.
- Adhering strictly to version control conventions, code formatting standards, and internal security protocols.
- Logging completed tasks, time allocations, and daily progress notes in the project management board.

3. Leave Policy

Interns are eligible for a basic leave allowance designed to accommodate essential personal needs, academic commitments, and medical issues. During a standard six-month internship term, interns accrue 1 day of paid personal leave per month worked, totaling up to 6 days for the full term.

To request personal or medical leave, interns must adhere to the following protocol:

- Submit an official leave request through the HR Portal at least 48 hours in advance for planned personal absences.
- For unexpected illness, notify your direct supervisor and HR via email before 9:00 AM on the day of absence.
- Unused leave does not carry over beyond the duration of your internship agreement and cannot be converted into cash payout.

Note on Overlapping Policy: Leave allowances for interns are set at 1 day/month (max 6 days). Additional PTO entitlements apply only to regular employees, managers, and executive staff.

4. Work From Home

Interns are generally required to work on-site at their designated office location to maximize collaboration,

5. Learning and Training

Learning and professional development are central to our internship program. Interns receive access to NovaTech's internal e-learning catalog, which includes curated video tracks for software engineering practices, cloud fundamentals, product design, data analytics, and project management.

Interns are expected to dedicate approximately 4 hours per week toward assigned self-paced learning modules. Upon completing basic tracks, interns can request access to specialized vendor certification paths after discussion with their assigned mentor.

6. Mentorship

Every intern is paired with a dedicated mentor who is a mid-level or senior professional within the same department. Your mentor serves as your primary guide for professional development, technical guidance, code reviews, and career advice.

Mentors conduct weekly 30-minute one-on-one sessions to review progress, provide constructive feedback on deliverables, address technical blockers, and help navigate organizational dynamics. Interns are encouraged to come prepared to these sessions with questions and discussion topics.

7. Attendance & Hours

Consistent attendance and punctuality are essential for a successful internship experience. Core business hours for all employees and interns are 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, Monday through Friday, with a standard one-hour lunch break.

If you anticipate being late or absent due to an emergency, notify your manager and mentor as early as possible. Repeated unexcused tardiness or absence may lead to a formal review and potential termination of the internship agreement.

8. Internship Evaluation

Intern progress is assessed at two key intervals during the program: a mid-term review (at week 12) and a final comprehensive evaluation (at week 24). Evaluations are conducted by your direct supervisor with qualitative input from your assigned mentor.

The evaluation criteria focus on five core pillars:

- Technical competency, problem-solving ability, and work quality.
- Initiative, self-motivation, and adaptability to feedback.
- Collaboration, written and verbal communication, and team integration.
- Timeliness and dependability in completing assigned project milestones.

High-performing interns who receive exemplary ratings on their final evaluation may be considered for full-time junior positions or extended internship terms upon completion of their academic studies.

9. Project Guidelines

Interns will work on a designated intern group project or directly contribute to ongoing customer-facing service repositories. When working on software or analytical deliverables, interns must follow internal repository guidelines:

- Always create separate feature branches off the primary integration branch; direct pushes to main are blocked.
- Ensure all code passes automated linting, security scans, and unit test suites prior to submitting pull requests.
- Submit pull requests for review by your mentor or a senior team member before merging